A SHIPPER'S RESOURCE

Philippine Trade Regulation Readiness Checklist

12 things to confirm before you book your next shipment, so nothing slips at the border.

Why Unclear Regulation Costs You

Businesses rarely lose time on the rule itself. They lose it by approaching the wrong agency, in the wrong order, with incomplete information. Mills Advisory helps you map the path first, working with Mills Permits and Mills Customs so each step builds on the last.

Work through each point before you book. If you cannot tick a box, that is the item to resolve first.

The Readiness Checklist

- ☐ **1. Your business purpose and product scope are written down**
  Write down what you plan to import or export, in what volumes and for what end use. Every later regulatory question depends on it.

- ☐ **2. The import structure has been reviewed**
  Confirm who will be the importer, who pays, and how the goods will be sold or used, and that this structure suits your business.

- ☐ **3. The agencies that apply are mapped**
  List the agencies that regulate your product and your business activity, so you approach the right office first and in the right order.

- ☐ **4. Required registrations are in place**
  Check that company and importer registrations needed for your activity are active and consistent in name and details.

- ☐ **5. Product-level approvals are identified**
  Confirm whether your product needs a permit, license or registration, and what each one requires before shipment.

- ☐ **6. Customs risk has been assessed**
  Review classification, valuation and origin for your main products, and note where an assessment could be questioned.

- ☐ **7. Government contact points are assigned**
  Decide who on your team or at your adviser will coordinate with agencies, so questions are answered quickly and consistently.

- ☐ **8. A document standard is agreed**
  Agree on one standard set of documents and naming for every shipment, so records match across agencies and your broker.

- ☐ **9. Timelines are checked against your plan**
  Compare each agency step with your purchase and shipping dates, and leave room for follow-up questions.

The Readiness Checklist (continued)

- [ ] **10. Post-clearance obligations are known**
  Know which records and follow-up filings are expected after release, and who will keep them.

- [ ] **11. A compliance routine exists**
  Set a simple routine for renewals, regulatory changes and periodic reviews, so approvals do not lapse unnoticed.

- [ ] **12. Professional support is lined up**
  Identify the lawyers, accountants or advisers you will involve for matters beyond routine customs work, and how they coordinate.

Not sure every box is ticked? Let Mills Advisory review it with you.

Book a short call and we will walk through your next shipment and flag anything to resolve before it moves.

BOOK A CALL

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General guidance only, not legal advice. Requirements vary by product and shipment; confirm with The Mills before booking.